

SPINACH *Spinacia oleracea*

Packed with vitamins and minerals, spinach is nutritious and has a delicious flavor; try the traditional thicker, wrinkled varieties for cooking, and thinner, smooth-leaved varieties for eating raw in salads. Happy to grow in cooler climates and shady positions, spinach is a very accommodating vegetable, however, be careful to keep it well-watered. Water more than once a day in hot, dry weather—since it will readily bolt.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Spinach prefers a fertile soil, so apply well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before planting, or apply a compound fertilizer shortly before sowing. Spinach is a very versatile plant; it will happily grow in containers as a cut-and-come-again crop and it is ideal for intercropping, since it will tolerate partial shade.

Spinach can be sown year-round to provide a constant crop, so sow seed every few weeks throughout the year between midwinter and late summer. Sow at a depth of .75 in (2 cm) and space your rows 12 in (30 cm) apart. When seedlings have established, thin out, giving them 3–6 in (7–15 cm) of space, depending on how big



Sow in pots if your space is limited.

you want them to grow. Sow cut-and-come-again crops in wide drills; dig a 6–8 in (15–20 cm) wide trench the length of your row and sow two lines of seeds within it.

CROP CARE

Keep spinach well-weeded and, most importantly, keep it well-watered to help prevent bolting. If growth is slow, feed with a nitrogenous fertilizer.